San Diego, CA: white-collar jobs and employment

Prepared for Point Loma Nazarene University by NextChapter Research · career-site data as of 2026-10-22 · draft

Summary

The sample is 1,106 white-collar postings from 51 employers' own career sites. 17% are health care, 2% are entry-level, 43% are senior individual contributor or above, and median stated pay is $154,900 a year.

- **Labor market:** unemployment was 4.9% in 2026-08, against 5.1% a year earlier; nonfarm employment changed 0.7% over twelve months.
- **Entry-level:** 25 white-collar postings across 9 employers.
- **AI:** 32.1% of white-collar postings mention AI; those pay a median of $142,450 against $155,250 for the rest.
- **Concentration:** Sharp HealthCare alone is 14% of all postings, so the mix reflects the largest readable employers more than the whole market.

Coverage

1,438 postings in the area were read from 51 employers, and 1,106 of them are white-collar (77%). Another 246 could not be classified from the title and are left out. The frame is every white-collar job at every level, entry-level included (Census major groups 1 and 2).

Employers on career systems we cannot read are missing, so read these figures as describing the employers listed, not every opening in the area.

Large employers we looked for and could not read: UC San Diego Health, University of California San Diego, San Diego Community College District, Rady Children's Health, Kaiser Permanente, Qualcomm, General Atomics, Intuit, Jack in the Box, Sempra, San Diego Gas & Electric, Biogen, Genentech, Grail.

Levels and functions

Level	Postings	Share
Entry	25	2%
Mid-level	606	55%
Senior individual contributor	207	19%
Manager	160	14%
Director	102	9%
VP and above	6	1%

Function	Postings	Entry-level	Employers	Median stated annual pay
Management, business and operations	218	3	30	$157,350
Technology and IT	190	7	18	$155,500
Healthcare practitioners	186	1	18	$135,912
Engineering and science	184	4	21	$149,787

Function	Postings	Entry-level	Employers	Median stated annual pay
Education and training	161	2	13	$171,000
Marketing, media and design	49	0	12	$182,750
Finance and accounting	45	2	14	$103,100
Legal	19	3	5	$235,736
Community and social service	17	0	6	$54,018
Supply chain and logistics	14	0	7	$111,692
Data and analytics	13	1	5	$157,350
HR and recruiting	10	2	8	$152,250

Employers, pay, AI and skills

Pay is stated in 79.7% of white-collar postings, with a median of $154,900 a year or $68.59 an hour.

Employer	All postings	White-collar	White-collar entry-level
Sharp HealthCare	195	129	1
Neurocrine Biosciences	116	112	0
Viasat, Inc.	107	103	0
Booz Allen Hamilton	108	97	4
Grossmont-Cuyamaca Community College District	87	87	0
Shield AI	80	78	1
Amazon	71	69	0
University of San Diego	67	52	8
Illumina	57	52	0
Point Loma Nazarene University	54	49	0
Dexcom	49	45	0
Leidos	37	33	0
County of San Diego	48	27	3
National University	22	19	3
Astrobotic	20	18	0
Abbott	14	13	0
Philips	14	13	2
US Bank	17	12	0
Humana	14	12	0
City of San Diego	31	10	2
Clark Construction	12	9	0
Cubic	10	9	1

Employer	All postings	White-collar	White-collar entry-level
PNC	12	6	0
Thermo Fisher	8	6	0
Thermo Fisher Scientific	8	6	0
JPMorgan Chase	10	5	0
Parsons	5	5	0
Cardinal Health	7	4	0
Palomar Health	12	3	0
Dick's Sporting Goods	9	3	0
Applied Medical	4	3	0
Sedgwick	5	2	0
Fifth Third	2	2	0
Natera	2	2	0
Zoll	2	2	0
iHeartMedia	3	1	0
Terminix	2	1	0

AI. 355 postings (32.1%) mention AI or machine learning. They pay a median of $142,450 against $155,250 for the rest, 59% are senior individual contributor or above (35% for the rest), and 41% mention remote or hybrid work (10% for the rest).

Work arrangement and type. 13.7% mention remote work and 16.7% hybrid. 17.0% are part-time. 25.2% use contract, temporary, fractional or similar words, a W-2 and 1099 signal combined.

Posting age. 15.0% of postings with a posted date went up more than 90 days ago. Reposts and ghost-job risk need a second crawl.

Soft skill named	Share of white-collar postings
Communication	72%
Collaboration	68%
Leadership	55%
Problem solving	28%
Adaptability	25%
Named tools	25%
Creativity	7%
Empathy	3%

Entry-level openings, a sample

Employer	Role
City of San Diego	Library Assistant II

Employer	Role	
$49,233.60 - $59,571.20 Annually		
University of San Diego	Executive Assistant I, College of Arts and Sciences	
Booz Allen Hamilton	University, 2027 Summer Games Cyber Security Intern - San Diego, CA	
University of San Diego	Housing Rights Clinic Legal Assistant/Paralegal	
University of San Diego	Part-Time Assistant Athletic Trainer	
University of San Diego	Program Assistant, Online Degree Programs	
National University	MultiUse Lab Assistant Supervisor (Spectrum Center)	Sp
Shield AI	Summer 2027 - Software Engineer Intern	
National University	Lab Assistant - Federal Work Study (Spectrum Center, San Diego, CA)	Sp
Booz Allen Hamilton	University - 2027 Summer Games Systems Engineer Intern - San Diego, CA	
Sharp HealthCare	Pathologists' Assistant - Copley Lab - Day Shift - Per Diem	
County of San Diego	Insect Detection Specialist I-Agriculture, Weights, and Measures-26540001AWM	
University of San Diego	Open Rank (Assistant, Associate or Full) Professor of English and Writing Program Director	
National University	Veteran Education Benefits Assistant – VA Work Study	Sp
Cubic	Systems Engineering Execution Intern	

Job-board feed: more openings, and exposure to AI

The NextChapter job-board feed holds 5,389 live postings in the area, 4,899 of them white-collar (91%). That is a wider net than the employer career sites above, and it includes aggregator and search-firm postings (41% of the feed), so it is shown as its own frame and never added to the career-site numbers. Each posting carries an occupation code matched to Anthropic's Economic Index; 73.4% were matched from the job title and the rest from the job function.

White-collar postings in the feed	Postings	Share
Entry and early career	1,018	21%
Individual contributor	2,142	44%
Management and above	1,739	35%

Jobs at risk: AI exposure of the openings

Anthropic rates each occupation's observed exposure to AI, which weighs real usage and automated uses more heavily than hypothetical capability. In this feed 9% of white-collar openings are in highly exposed occupations, 36% in medium and 56% in low. Among entry and early-career openings, 11% are in highly exposed occupations. Exposure is not a forecast of job loss: Anthropic found no systematic rise in unemployment for exposed workers so far, with early signs that hiring of younger workers has slowed in exposed occupations.

Most-posted occupations	Postings	AI exposure
Software Developers	374	medium
General and Operations Managers	264	low

Most-posted occupations	Postings	AI exposure
Engineers, All Other	251	low
Lawyers	214	medium
Project Management Specialists	206	medium
Marketing Managers	179	medium
Computer Systems Engineers/Architects	178	high
Financial Managers	171	medium
Sales Managers	165	low
Business Operations Specialists, All Other	151	low
Electrical Engineers	138	low
Architectural and Engineering Managers	128	low

Highly exposed occupations with the most openings	Postings
Computer Systems Engineers/Architects	178
Data Scientists	77
Information Security Engineers	38
Market Research Analysts and Marketing Specialists	36
Web and Digital Interface Designers	32
Business Intelligence Analysts	25
Computer Systems Analysts	23
Mathematicians	5

Directional only. Retraining paths (related occupations with lower exposure and stronger projected growth) are the next addition.

Peer metros

Metro (BLS, 2026-08)	Unemployment rate	Year ago	Change (pts)	Nonfarm jobs (thousands)	12-month change
Riverside, CA	5.9%	6.2%	-0.3	1,712.2	+0.7%
Sacramento, CA	5.2%	5.4%	-0.2	1,109.3	+0.8%
San Diego, CA	4.9%	5.1%	-0.2	1,567.0	+0.7%
Phoenix, AZ	4.9%	4.3%	+0.6	2,463.8	+0.9%
Los Angeles, CA	4.8%	5.8%	-1.0	6,289.1	+0.6%
Seattle, WA	4.8%	4.8%	+0.0	2,143.9	+0.9%
San Francisco, CA	4.6%	4.9%	-0.3	2,427.2	+0.6%

BLS figures cover the whole metro. Posting comparisons use the same crawl and tagging in each metro but different employers, so read them as indicative.

Metro (career-site postings)	White-collar postings	Employers	Entry	Mid-level	Senior and above	Median annual pay	Mention AI
San Diego, CA	1,106	51	2%	55%	43%	$154,900	32.1%

Method and limits

- Source: employers' own career sites, crawled 2026-10-22, tagged by job title with fixed rules; titles that cannot be classified are excluded.
- AI, remote, hybrid and soft-skill figures are keyword matches in posting text; pay medians use only postings that state pay.
- Postings are not BLS job openings: one opening can have several postings and some are always open.
- There is no history yet. Functions gaining or losing, reposts and ghost-job risk need at least two crawls.
- Labor market data: BLS Local Area Unemployment Statistics and Current Employment Statistics bulk files, not seasonally adjusted.

Sources: employers' own career sites; U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics (LAUS, CES); O*NET. Figures describe the employers listed, not every opening in the area.